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DEPARTMENT OF STATE
WASHINGTON

December 2. 1943

MEMORANDUM FOR THE PRESIDENT

SUBJECT: Ambassador Gauss' despatch No. 1693 on China's War Effort

An interesting despatch dated October 18 has recently been received from Ambassador Gauss. The conclusion of the despatch is as follows:

> "In conclusion, I would say that while we have perhaps succeeded in impressing upon some officials the need for increased and more effective war effort on the part of China and while also there may be resulting some minor improvement in some aspects of the situation, we cannot safely count under present conditions (which involve of course the question of equipment for the Chinese forces) on effecting any significant psychological change in the Chinese attitude which will impel China's leaders and soldiers to put forth materially greater effort in the war against Japan. The Chinese have persuaded themselves that the war in Europe will shortly end and that the United States, possibly with help from Great Britain, will defeat Japan; that the Chinese are too tired and too worn and too ill-equipped to make greater effort, especially when such effort may not be necessary; and that the Chinese can sit back, holding what they have against the Japanese, and concentrate their planning upon China's post-war political and economic problems."

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